

Author purpose - Workbook 3

Focused practice - Workbook 3 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Neighborhood Trees

An article explains that street trees can shade pavement, slow some stormwater, and provide habitat. It also notes that young trees need watering and adequate soil space.

1. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. give a balanced explanation of benefits and maintenance needs of street trees
- B. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- C. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

2. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. The maintenance information qualifies the benefits by showing what healthy trees require.
- C. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- D. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.

Quiet Zone FAQ

A transit agency FAQ explains what counts as a quiet-zone car, whether phone calls are allowed, how announcements are handled, and what riders should do if another passenger is noisy.

3. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- B. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- C. clarify the rules and expectations for quiet-zone train cars
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

4. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- C. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.
- D. The question-and-answer format addresses practical situations riders are likely to wonder about.

River Path Proposal

A planning document proposes extending a riverside path to connect two neighborhoods. It includes a map, estimated cost, expected daily use, and two concerns raised at a public meeting.

5. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. present a proposed path extension and information needed to evaluate it
- B. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- C. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

6. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. Including concerns shows that the proposal has tradeoffs as well as expected benefits.
- C. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- D. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. Give a balanced explanation of benefits and maintenance needs of street trees.
2. B. The maintenance information qualifies the benefits by showing what healthy trees require.
3. C. Clarify the rules and expectations for quiet-zone train cars.
4. D. The question-and-answer format addresses practical situations riders are likely to wonder about.
5. A. Present a proposed path extension and information needed to evaluate it.
6. B. Including concerns shows that the proposal has tradeoffs as well as expected benefits.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.